

ICE ROBUSTA COFFEE FUTURES (RC)

"Coffee 409" — Spread & Curve Structure Fundamental Reference
Vietnam, the Instant Coffee Chain, and the Relationship to Coffee C
(Arabica)

This document presents a fact-based reference on the fundamental drivers of ICE Robusta Coffee futures (ticker: RC), traded on ICE Futures Europe and still commonly referred to in the trade by its legacy designation, "Coffee 409" or simply "the 409s," a name inherited from the contract's historical listing number on the London terminal market system that predates the exchange's various corporate mergers (London Commodity Exchange / LIFFE / Euronext.liffe / ICE Futures Europe). The "409" designation refers to a legacy contract-code convention rather than to any current product specification, but the name remains in routine market use. Robusta is one of the two principal coffee species traded on organised futures markets; the other, Arabica, is priced via ICE Coffee C (ticker KC, ICE Futures US), the subject of a separate reference document produced earlier in this series. Because Robusta and Arabica are different botanical species with distinct growing geography, quality characteristics, and end uses — connected primarily through blending and instant-coffee substitution economics rather than through a shared physical supply chain — this document presents the Robusta-specific fundamentals in full and includes a dedicated, fact-only comparison section addressing every material difference between RC and Coffee C.

Futures First — Internal Education Material
For Analyst Group Use

1. Contract Specifications and Delivery Mechanics

ICE Robusta Coffee is a physically delivered contract for green (unroasted) Robusta coffee beans, distinct in underlying species, currency, contract size, and delivery calendar from the Arabica-based Coffee C contract.

Parameter	Detail
Exchange	ICE Futures Europe (the contract traces its lineage through the London Commodity Exchange, the London FOX, LIFFE, and Euronext.liffe before ICE's acquisition of the NYSE Euronext commodities business in 2013)
Ticker	RC (front month); widely known in the trade as "Coffee 409" or "the 409s," a legacy designation rather than a current product code
Underlying	Green (unroasted) Robusta coffee beans (<i>Coffea canephora</i>)
Contract size	10 metric tonnes
Quotation	US dollars per metric tonne (USD/MT)
Contract months	January, March, May, July, September, November — six delivery months per year (an even-month-skip pattern providing ten delivery months available for trading across the listed forward curve at any time, per exchange convention). This is a different calendar structure from Coffee C's five-month (March/May/July/September/December) cycle.
Settlement type	Physical delivery via warehouse receipt at an ICE-nominated warehouse located in either Europe or the United States — a dual-continent delivery system distinct from Coffee C's US-based delivery system.
Delivery grade	Class 1 Robusta Coffee deliverable at contract price; other qualities (by origin and grade) deliverable at set exchange-defined premiums and discounts to the Class 1 standard.
Last trading day	The fourth business day preceding the last business day of the delivery month
First notice/tender day	The fourth business day preceding the first business day of the delivery month
Relationship to Coffee C	Coffee C (KC, ICE Futures US, Arabica, ¢/lb) is the Arabica benchmark. The Arabica-Robusta spread, after unit conversion, is a key cross-species relative value relationship — see Section 10.5 for the full comparison.

1.1 Why Robusta and Arabica Trade as Separate Contracts

- Robusta (*Coffea canephora*) and Arabica (*Coffea arabica*) are different coffee species with distinct agronomic requirements, cup characteristics, and end-use profiles (detailed in Section 2 and Section 5). Because the two species are not interchangeable on a one-for-one basis in most applications, and because they are grown in substantially different geographies, the futures market has historically priced them as separate, independently deliverable contracts rather than as a single blended-species instrument.
- "Class 1 Robusta"**: the contract delivery standard, referring to a defined quality grade specification (bean size, defect count, moisture) for Robusta beans, analogous in function to (though numerically and qualitatively distinct from) the origin-differential system used for Coffee C.

1.2 The Dual-Continent Delivery System

- RC permits delivery at ICE-nominated warehouses in either Europe or the United States, a structural feature not shared by Coffee C, which delivers exclusively into US warehouses. This dual-continent delivery system reflects Robusta's historically more globally distributed consuming-market base (Europe, Asia, and the US instant coffee and blend manufacturing sectors all hold material demand) compared to Arabica, where specialty and premium-roast demand has historically been more concentrated in fewer consuming regions relative to total Robusta demand geography.

2. Robusta as a Species — Agronomy and Quality Characteristics

Understanding Robusta's distinct agronomic profile relative to Arabica is the starting point for understanding why its production geography, cost structure, and demand base differ as much as they do.

2.1 Growing Conditions

- **Altitude and climate:** Robusta is grown predominantly at lower altitudes (generally below 800 metres, often near sea level) in hot, humid equatorial and near-equatorial climates, in contrast to Arabica's preference for higher-altitude (600–2,000+ metre), cooler subtropical growing conditions. This fundamental climate requirement difference is the primary reason the two species are grown in substantially different — though in some countries overlapping — geographies.
- **Disease resistance and yield:** Robusta is generally more resistant to coffee leaf rust (the disease that has caused significant Arabica production losses in Central America and elsewhere, as detailed in the Coffee C reference document) and is higher-yielding per hectare than Arabica under comparable cultivation intensity, contributing to its generally lower production cost per unit of output.
- **Caffeine content and cup profile:** Robusta beans contain roughly double the caffeine content of Arabica beans on average, and produce a more bitter, less aromatically complex cup with a thicker body — characteristics that make it well-suited to its primary end uses (Section 5) but generally regarded in the trade as lower "cup quality" than Arabica for straight, unblended consumption.

2.2 Tree Biology and Harvest Cycle

- Robusta trees can produce a commercial harvest somewhat sooner after planting than Arabica in some growing systems, and — like Arabica — are subject to some degree of biennial bearing tendency, though this is generally regarded as less pronounced and less uniformly documented at a national-crop level than the biennial pattern described for Brazilian Arabica in the Coffee C reference document.

3. Global Production — Vietnam's Dominance

World Robusta production is concentrated far more heavily in a single country than is the case for Arabica: Vietnam alone accounts for a substantial majority of global Robusta exports, making Vietnamese supply conditions the single most important fundamental variable for the RC contract — analogous in structural importance to Brazil's role in the Arabica/Coffee C market.

Country	Approx. Share of World Robusta Production	Harvest Period	Key Risk	RC Curve Impact
Vietnam	~40–45% of world Robusta	Oct-Jan harvest (Central Highlands — Dak Lak province dominant)	Drought (ENSO-linked); farmer crop-switching to durian/pepper in low-price periods; smallholder farming structure	By far the dominant supply variable. Vietnamese harvest size and export pace move the entire curve.
Brazil (Conilon)	~20–25% of world Robusta	Harvested alongside but logistically and varietally distinct from Brazilian Arabica; concentrated in Espírito Santo and Bahia states	Drought; BRL/USD farmer-selling economics (the same mechanism described for Brazilian Arabica and sugar in earlier reference documents)	Second-largest source; Brazilian Conilon competes directly with Vietnamese Robusta for the same global blending and instant-coffee demand pool.
Indonesia	~8–10% of world Robusta	Apr-Sep (varies by island — Sumatra, Java, Sulawesi)	ENSO-driven rainfall variability; smallholder farming structure	Significant secondary Robusta producer relevant to Asian instant coffee supply chains.
Uganda	~5–6% of world Robusta	Two harvest peaks per year given Uganda's bimodal rainfall pattern	Regional political/logistics factors; smallholder structure	Significant African Robusta origin; relevant to the European and Middle Eastern import market.
India	~3–4% of world Robusta	Oct-Jan (overlapping with India's smaller Arabica harvest)	Monsoon variability	Secondary contributor to the global Robusta balance.
Côte d'Ivoire, Cameroon, other West/Central African origins	~5–8% combined	Varies	Regional weather and logistics factors; some overlap with cocoa-growing regions and labour/land use competition	Collectively relevant secondary supply, particularly for European import markets.

3.1 Vietnamese Production Structure

- **Central Highlands dominance:** Dak Lak, Lam Dong, Gia Lai, and Dak Nong provinces account for the substantial majority of Vietnamese Robusta production, grown predominantly by smallholder farmers — the same production geography described in the Coffee C reference document's treatment of Vietnam as a Robusta supplier to the broader global coffee market.
- **ENSO sensitivity:** Vietnamese Robusta yields are sensitive to ENSO-driven rainfall variability, with El Niño years historically associated with drought stress and reduced yields, and La Niña years tending to bring more favourable growing-season rainfall.

- **Crop-switching risk:** during periods of sustained low Robusta prices, Vietnamese smallholders have at times shifted land toward alternative crops (durian, black pepper, and others) offering better relative returns — a multi-year supply-side response, since replanting decisions take years to fully reverse, identical in mechanism to the dynamic described in the Coffee C reference document.
- **Vietnam Customs and VICOFA export data:** Vietnamese export statistics, published by Vietnam Customs and tracked by the Vietnam Coffee and Cocoa Association (VICOFA), are the primary near-real-time indicator of Vietnamese Robusta supply reaching the global market and are the single most closely watched data series for the RC contract specifically.

4. Brazilian Conilon and Other Key Origins

4.1 Brazilian Conilon Robusta

- Brazil produces Robusta coffee under the local name "Conilon," grown predominantly in the states of Espírito Santo and Bahia — geographically and climatically distinct from the Minas Gerais, São Paulo, and Paraná growing regions that dominate Brazilian Arabica production (described in the Coffee C reference document). Conilon harvest timing and weather risk are tracked separately from Brazilian Arabica weather risk, including the specific frost-risk framework described for Arabica, since Conilon's lower-altitude, generally warmer growing regions carry a different — and generally lower — frost exposure than the higher-altitude Arabica regions further south and at higher elevation.
- **CONAB Conilon estimates:** Brazil's National Supply Company (CONAB) publishes Conilon production estimates as part of its broader coffee crop reporting, alongside but distinct from its Arabica estimates, providing a Brazil-specific Robusta supply data series relevant to RC.
- **BRL/USD and Conilon farmer economics:** as with Brazilian Arabica, sugar, and other BRL-priced agricultural exports, Brazilian Real depreciation improves the BRL-equivalent revenue Conilon farmers receive at a given USD price, incentivising selling and export — the same currency mechanism described throughout this document series for Brazilian commodities.

4.2 Uganda, Indonesia, and West/Central Africa

- Uganda's bimodal rainfall pattern produces two harvest peaks per year, providing a more continuous, less single-event-dependent supply flow than countries with a single concentrated harvest window. Ugandan Robusta is a significant origin for the European and Middle Eastern import markets specifically.
- Indonesian Robusta production (Sumatra, Java, Sulawesi) is relevant primarily to Asian instant coffee and blend manufacturing supply chains, with production timing and ENSO sensitivity broadly similar in mechanism to the Indonesian production profile described in the Coffee C reference document.

5. Demand — Instant Coffee, Blends, and Espresso

Robusta's demand base is structurally distinct from Arabica's, concentrated in applications where its cost advantage, caffeine content, and specific flavour/body characteristics are valued rather than penalised.

5.1 Instant (Soluble) Coffee — The Traditional Core Market

- Instant coffee manufacturing — the dominant traditional end use for Robusta — relies heavily on Robusta's lower cost and higher caffeine extraction efficiency relative to Arabica. Major global instant coffee manufacturers source Robusta as a primary input, making the instant coffee sector's production volumes and capacity utilisation a structurally important demand signal for RC, analogous in role to the specialty coffee segment's importance for Coffee C (though representing essentially the opposite end of the value/cost spectrum within the broader coffee market).
- **Geographic distribution of instant coffee demand:** instant coffee consumption is particularly significant in markets including Eastern Europe, Russia, parts of Asia, and the UK, relative to markets such as the US and continental Western Europe, where roast-and-ground and espresso-format consumption represent a larger share of total coffee consumption — a geographic demand pattern distinct from Arabica's consumption geography described in the Coffee C reference document.

5.2 Espresso Blending

- Traditional Italian-style espresso blends frequently include a Robusta component (sometimes a substantial one), valued for the crema (the foam layer on a properly extracted espresso shot) and body that Robusta contributes to the blend, alongside Arabica's contribution of aromatic complexity and acidity. This blending role represents a demand segment for Robusta with somewhat higher quality requirements than commodity instant coffee manufacturing, and has, per industry sources, grown to include "fine Robusta" initiatives targeting improved processing and quality specifically for this application.

5.3 Lower-Cost Roast-and-Ground Blends

- Beyond espresso, Robusta is also used as a cost-reduction component in lower-priced roast-and-ground retail coffee blends in many markets, where a Robusta-Arabica blend ratio is adjusted by manufacturers to manage input costs — the same substitution mechanism described from the Arabica side in the Coffee C reference document (Section 1.2 of that document), operating here from the Robusta producer/buyer perspective.

6. ICE Certified Stocks and the Physical Market

As with Coffee C, ICE-certified Robusta stocks — green Robusta coffee held in ICE-nominated warehouses and graded as deliverable against the RC contract — are a closely watched data series for assessing physical market tightness.

- **Daily publication:** ICE publishes certified Robusta stock data, broken down by warehouse location across the dual-continent (Europe/US) delivery system described in Section 1.2 — a structurally different reporting geography from Coffee C's US-only certified stock system.
- **The multi-year tightness episode:** as referenced in the Coffee C reference document's discussion of the 2023–2024 period, Vietnamese drought-linked Robusta supply tightness coincided with strong global demand, contributing to record or near-record Robusta prices during that period and a notable narrowing of the historical Arabica premium over Robusta — an episode in which RC-specific certified stock and Vietnamese export data were the primary real-time indicators market participants used to track the evolving physical tightness.
- **Decertification and recertification flow:** as with other ICE soft commodity contracts, Robusta coffee can be decertified (withdrawn from the certified pool) and newly graded coffee can be certified as it passes inspection, with the flow rate providing additional context on physical market tightness beyond the absolute stock level alone.

7. The Forward Curve Structure

RC trades in six delivery months per year (January, March, May, July, September, November), a different calendar pattern from Coffee C's five-month (March, May, July, September, December) cycle — see Section 10.1 for the direct comparison.

Contract Window	Primary Fundamental Driver	Secondary Driver	Key Signal
Nov-Jan (Vietnamese harvest)	Vietnamese harvest size and early export pace (Oct-Jan harvest window)	Brazilian Conilon harvest timing; Indonesian crop conditions	Vietnam Customs/VICOFA weekly-to-monthly export data; early CONAB Conilon estimates
Mar-May (post-Vietnamese-harvest marketing)	Vietnamese export pace vs prior-year and forecast pace; farmer/trader selling behaviour	Ugandan harvest contribution; certified stock trend	Cumulative Vietnamese export data; ICE certified Robusta stocks
Jul-Sep (Northern Hemisphere off-season for Vietnam)	Global instant coffee and blend manufacturing demand pace; certified stock drawdown	Brazilian Conilon export pace; Indonesian mid-year crop conditions	Certified stock trend; instant coffee manufacturer commentary/capacity utilisation

7.1 Carry and Backwardation

- As with Coffee C, RC backwardation (nearby trading at a premium to deferred) signals near-term physical scarcity — low certified stocks, strong immediate demand from instant coffee and blend manufacturers, or a confirmed Vietnamese or Brazilian Conilon supply disruption. Normal-market contango reflects storage, financing, and insurance costs for holding physical green Robusta, with green Robusta generally considered to store at least as well as green Arabica under proper conditions.

8. Macro, Currency, and Cross-Market Drivers

8.1 Vietnamese Dong (VND/USD) and Brazilian Real (BRL/USD)

- VND/USD operates analogously to the BRL/USD mechanism described throughout this document series: Vietnamese Dong depreciation improves the dong-equivalent revenue Vietnamese farmers and traders receive at a given USD Robusta price, incentivising selling and export.
- BRL/USD affects Brazilian Conilon farmer economics through the identical mechanism described for Brazilian Arabica, sugar, and other BRL-priced exports in earlier reference documents in this series.

8.2 ENSO and Weather

- As detailed in Section 3, Vietnamese, Indonesian, and (to a lesser extent) Ugandan Robusta production are each sensitive to ENSO-driven rainfall variability, with El Niño years historically associated with drought stress and reduced yields across these origins, and La Niña years generally more favourable — the same ENSO framework described for these countries in the Coffee C reference document's Robusta-relevant discussion.

8.3 Freight and Logistics

- Robusta's dual-continent delivery system and its significant export volumes from Vietnam (Ho Chi Minh City port) to both European and global instant coffee manufacturing centres make ocean freight costs and shipping-route disruptions (such as the documented Red Sea shipping disruptions affecting Asia-Europe routings) a relevant basis and logistics-cost variable, broadly analogous to the freight considerations described for Coffee C but operating over a somewhat different primary trade route (Vietnam-to-Europe being especially exposed to Suez/Red Sea routing considerations).

8.4 Speculative Positioning

- As an ICE Futures Europe-listed contract, RC is subject to the UK/EU market position-reporting framework rather than the US CFTC's Commitments of Traders regime that applies to Coffee C — the same regulatory-regime distinction described for the CC/XC cocoa pair and the No. 11/XW sugar pair elsewhere in this document series applies here in an analogous way (see Section 10.4).

9. Documented Seasonal Patterns

Robusta's seasonal pattern is anchored to the Vietnamese harvest calendar (October-January) in the way Arabica's seasonal pattern is anchored to the Brazilian Arabica calendar (April-September harvest, June-August frost-risk window) — though without an equivalent to Arabica's frost-risk phenomenon, since Robusta's lower-altitude, warmer growing regions do not carry meaningful frost exposure.

Period	Vietnamese Crop Stage	Typical RC Behaviour	Reliability
Oct-Jan	Harvest underway and concluding	Early harvest-size signals and weather during the harvest window are the dominant driver; a confirmed below-pace or above-pace harvest can move the curve materially	Moderate-High
Feb-May	Post-harvest marketing; farmer/trader selling pace	Export data confirms or revises the harvest-size picture; certified stock trend becomes relevant	Moderate
Jun-Sep	Off-season; new-crop flowering and early development	Lower data frequency; demand-side (instant coffee manufacturing pace) and ENSO forecast updates for the upcoming season take a larger relative role	Lower — fewer high-frequency catalysts than the harvest window

10. RC ("Coffee 409") vs Coffee C (KC) — Comparison of Differences

This section catalogues every material, verifiable difference between ICE Robusta Coffee (RC) and ICE Coffee C (KC, Arabica). It is presented as a factual reference only and does not take a position on which contract is preferable for any particular hedging or trading purpose, since that depends on the specific physical exposure (Robusta vs Arabica) or trading objective involved.

10.1 Underlying Species, Exchange, and Contract Terms

Dimension	RC (Robusta, "Coffee 409")	Coffee C (KC, Arabica)
Underlying species	Coffea canephora (Robusta)	Coffea arabica (Arabica)
Exchange	ICE Futures Europe (legacy London Commodity Exchange / LIFFE / Euronext.liffe)	ICE Futures US (legacy NYBOT / CSCE)
Currency	US dollars (USD)	US dollars (USD) — identical currency to RC
Quotation unit	USD per metric tonne	US cents per pound
Contract size	10 metric tonnes	37,500 lb (≈17 metric tonnes) — not the same tonnage as RC
Contract months	Jan/Mar/May/Jul/Sep/Nov (6 months/year)	Mar/May/Jul/Sep/Dec (5 months/year) — different calendar, different month spacing
Delivery geography	ICE-nominated warehouses in Europe OR the United States — dual-continent system	ICE-licensed warehouses in the United States only
Delivery grade basis	"Class 1 Robusta" standard with origin/quality premiums and discounts	Origin-and-processing differential system (washed vs natural, ~20+ approved origins) — a more elaborate origin-differential structure than RC's

10.2 Currency — A Point of Similarity, Not Difference

- Both RC and Coffee C are themselves denominated and settled in US dollars. Unlike the CC/XC cocoa pair (USD vs GBP) but similarly to the No. 11/XW sugar pair, a trader holding offsetting positions in RC and Coffee C is not, by virtue of the contracts' own denomination, taking on an additional direct currency-conversion exposure between the two legs — though both remain separately exposed to their respective producer-currency dynamics (VND for Vietnam/RC; BRL for Brazil, relevant to both contracts given Brazil's significant production of both species).

10.3 Quotation Convention

- RC is quoted in US dollars per metric tonne, the convention inherited from its London/European origins (the same convention used by London Cocoa and White Sugar No. 5, both described elsewhere in this series). Coffee C is quoted in US cents per pound, the convention inherited from its NYBOT/CSCE origins (the same convention used by ICE Sugar No. 11 and ICE Cotton No. 2). Converting between the two for comparison purposes requires a weight-unit conversion (pounds to metric tonnes) but, since both are USD-denominated, no currency conversion.

10.4 Regulatory Regime and Positioning Data

- As with the CC/XC cocoa pair and the No. 11/XW sugar pair, RC (ICE Futures Europe) is subject to the UK/EU market position-reporting framework, while Coffee C (ICE Futures US) is subject to US CFTC oversight and the weekly CFTC Commitments of Traders reporting framework — two distinct regulatory regimes and reporting datasets, not a single shared global coffee positioning report.

10.5 The Arabica-Robusta Spread — The Defining Cross-Species Relationship

- Because Robusta and Arabica are different botanical species grown predominantly in different countries (Vietnam/Brazil-Conilon/Indonesia/Uganda for Robusta versus Brazil-Arabica/Colombia/Central America/Ethiopia for Arabica, per Section 3 here and Section 2 of the Coffee C reference document), the Arabica-Robusta spread is not a refining-margin relationship in the way the No. 11/XW White Premium is (Section 10.5 of the White Sugar reference document), nor a currency-driven relationship in the way the CC/XC cocoa relationship partly is (Section 10.5 of the NYBOT Cocoa reference document). It is, instead, fundamentally a **blending and substitution relationship**: roasters and instant coffee manufacturers adjust the Arabica-Robusta content ratio of their products in response to the relative price of the two species, within the bounds of what consumers will accept in terms of taste change and subject to a meaningful reformulation lag (described in Section 1.2 of the Coffee C reference document).
- **Independent supply shocks**: because the two species are grown in different countries under different climate regimes, a supply shock affecting one (e.g., a Brazilian Arabica frost event, which has no Robusta equivalent given Robusta's low-altitude growing regions) does not mechanically affect the other species' supply directly — the connection between the two markets runs through the demand-side substitution channel described above, not through a shared production base.
- **The 2023-2024 documented episode**: as referenced in Section 6 and in the Coffee C reference document, a period of Vietnamese drought-linked Robusta supply tightness (linked to El Niño conditions) coincided with strong demand, producing record or near-record Robusta prices and a notable narrowing of the historical Arabica premium over Robusta — a documented, real-world illustration of the substitution-driven relationship connecting the two contracts in practice.

10.6 What Is Different in Underlying Supply Drivers

- RC's dominant supply variable is the Vietnamese harvest (Oct-Jan), with no equivalent to Arabica's biennial bearing cycle being as prominently documented at the national level, and critically, no equivalent at all to Arabica's Brazilian frost-risk phenomenon, since Robusta's lower-altitude growing regions in Vietnam, Brazil (Conilon), Indonesia, and Uganda do not experience the polar-air-mass frost events that affect Brazil's higher-altitude southern Arabica regions.
- Coffee C's dominant supply variable is the Brazilian Arabica harvest and its associated frost-risk window — a weather hazard with no parallel in the Robusta-growing geography — combined with the leaf rust (roya) disease risk that affects Arabica more than the generally more rust-resistant Robusta.

10.7 What Is Identical or Closely Shared Between the Two Contracts

- Both contracts are USD-denominated (Section 10.2); both are subject to ENSO-driven weather risk in their respective producing countries, albeit through different specific mechanisms and different countries (Section 8.2); both rely on ICE daily certified stock data and similar decertification/recertification flow dynamics as a physical tightness signal (Section 6); and the prices of the two are connected — though not mechanically linked — through the blending/substitution channel described in Section 10.5, which is the single most important analytical relationship for any trader working across both contracts.

11. Key Data Sources and Release Schedule

Report	Publisher	Frequency	Typical Timing	Relevance
Vietnam Customs / VICOFA export data	Vietnam Customs / Vietnam Coffee and Cocoa Association	Monthly (some weekly trade estimates)	Variable	RC-specific — the single most important recurring data series for the contract
CONAB Conilon (Brazilian Robusta) estimates	CONAB (Brazil)	Several times per year	Varies	RC-specific — Brazilian Robusta supply, distinct from CONAB's Arabica estimates
ICE certified Robusta stocks	ICE Futures Europe	Daily	After close	RC-specific — dual-continent (Europe/US) warehouse system distinct from Coffee C's
USDA FAS Coffee: World Markets and Trade	USDA FAS	Semi-annual	June and December	Shared with Coffee C — covers both Arabica and Robusta production/consumption/stocks
ICO Coffee Market Report	International Coffee Organization	Monthly	~Mid-month	Shared with Coffee C — composite indicators covering both species
NOAA ENSO forecast update	NOAA CPC / IRI	Monthly	~Mid-month	Relevant to Vietnam, Indonesia, and Uganda Robusta production specifically
VND/USD and BRL/USD exchange rates	Reuters / Bloomberg / State Bank of Vietnam / BCB	Daily / Continuous	Market hours	Vietnamese and Brazilian (Conilon) farmer/exporter selling economics
UK/EU market position-reporting data (RC)	ICE Futures Europe / relevant EU regulator	Periodic per regime	Variable	RC-specific positioning dataset under a different regulatory regime than Coffee C's CFTC COT
Global container/bulk freight rate indices	Freightos, Baltic Exchange, others	Weekly	Variable	Basis — Vietnam-to-Europe and other origin-to-destination route cost competitiveness

ICE Robusta Coffee (RC) and ICE Coffee C (KC) price two distinct coffee species grown in largely separate geographies — Vietnam, Brazilian Conilon, Indonesia, and Uganda for Robusta; Brazilian Arabica, Colombia, Central America, and Ethiopia for Arabica — connected primarily through the demand-side blending and substitution economics of roasters and instant coffee manufacturers rather than through a shared production base or a refining-margin relationship of the kind seen in the sugar No. 11/White Sugar pair. The two contracts share USD denomination but differ in quotation convention, contract size, delivery month calendar, delivery geography, and regulatory/positioning-data regime.

A trader working across both contracts needs to track the RC-specific fundamentals (the Vietnamese harvest calendar and export pace, Brazilian Conilon conditions, instant coffee manufacturing demand), the Coffee C-specific fundamentals (the Brazilian Arabica frost-risk window, the biennial bearing cycle, leaf rust disease risk), and the Arabica-Robusta spread itself as the distinct substitution-driven relative value relationship connecting the two markets.